

maintaining a consistent schedule. Once you get comfortable in your posting schedule you can then pay closer to attention to maintaining and enhancing the quality of your content.

By paying attention to the quality of your blog posts and keeping focused on your topic area, you are doing two things. One, you are consciously or involuntarily educating yourself in the subject area. This will make you something of an expert in your area of interest. Second, you are positioning yourself as a trustworthy source of information on that particular topic. These two factors will act as the reinforcing ‘glue’ that will keep attracting visitors back to your site.

For the first few months forget about traffic and concentrate on building traffic. Be thankful if you receive any comments—positive, negative or indifferent—on your blog. If people are staying long enough to read your blog post and comment on it, then you’re doing something right.

Hook in a free program like Google Analytics (<http://www.google.com/analytics>) to keep track of traffic growth and to understand how your visitors are reaching your site—where they come from, how often they come—new and returning visitors, what search terms they use to find your site and what are the most popular posts they visit.

Once you get an idea of your visitor patterns, you can then go about trying to improve on this by creating more content with reference to the same thing. For example if your most popular post was about a vacation in an exotic location, you may want to do a follow up story about the same place. You could also sell advertising space to tour companies in that area. However, this decision should be consistent with your monetization strategy (see section 4.3) and your blog theme. If for example, if your blog theme is about digital photography and the vacation post is primarily to illustrate the techniques you used to in taking those awesome shots then another post on the subject of vacations maybe inappropriate.